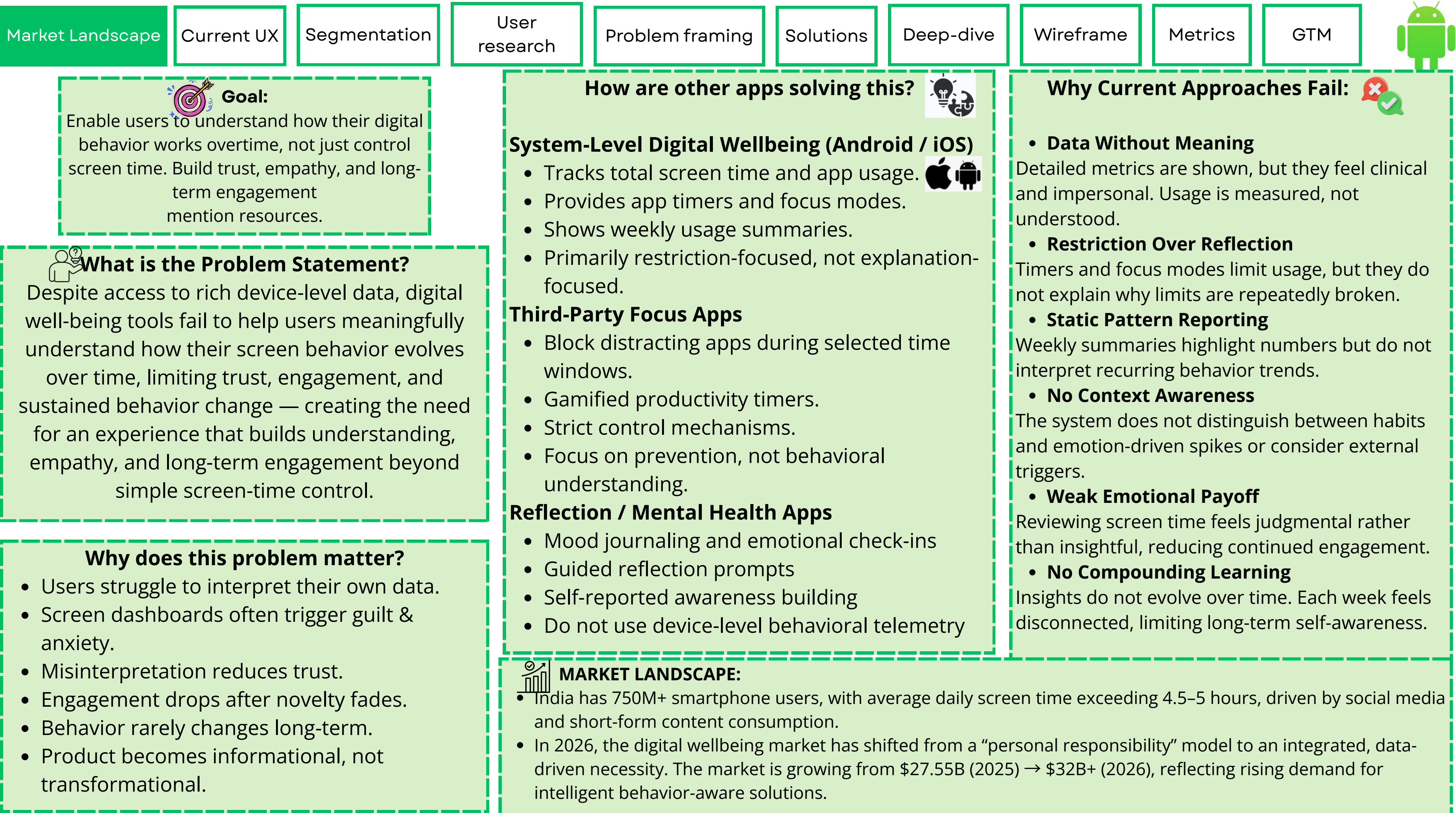




Current State Audit of Android Wellbeing app

Entry Experience:

Android Digital Wellbeing is accessed through the Settings app. It is positioned as a system-level utility within device controls rather than a standalone behavioral product.

Dashboard:

The dashboard presents total daily screen time, app-level rankings, unlock counts, and notification counts in a clear circular visualization format. The layout prioritizes time visibility and usage transparency.

Control Layer:

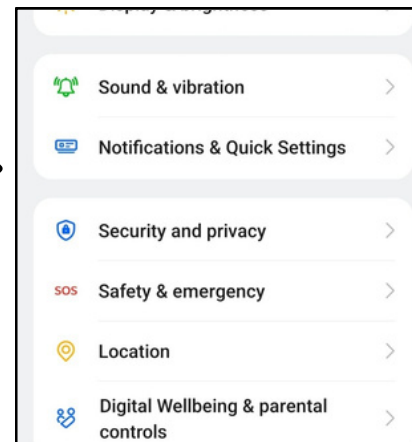
The ecosystem provides app timers, Focus Mode, and limit alerts to enable users to restrict usage. These controls allow for immediate intervention and manual behavior management.

Weekly Report:

Users receive weekly summaries showing total usage and percentage increase or decrease compared to the previous week. The system emphasizes comparative tracking.

Emotional Interaction:

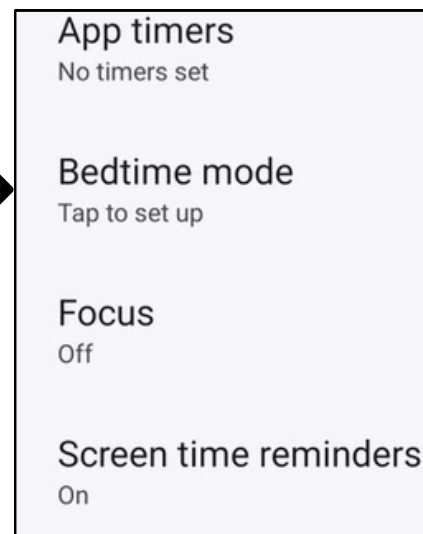
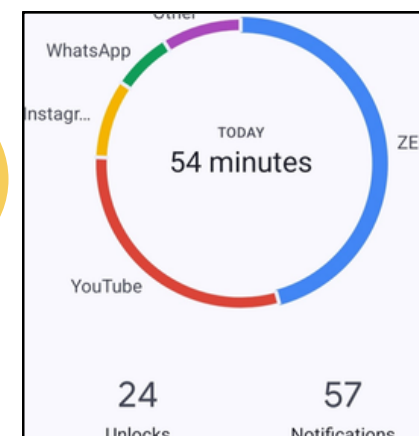
The weekly summary visually highlights increases using red indicators, drawing attention to usage spikes and trend changes.



Hmm, where do i find this digital wellbeing feature?



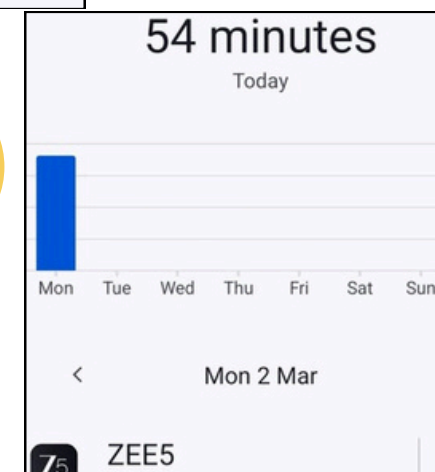
Hmm, numbers again.... but what's the story?



Hmm, I can just override this timer anyway..

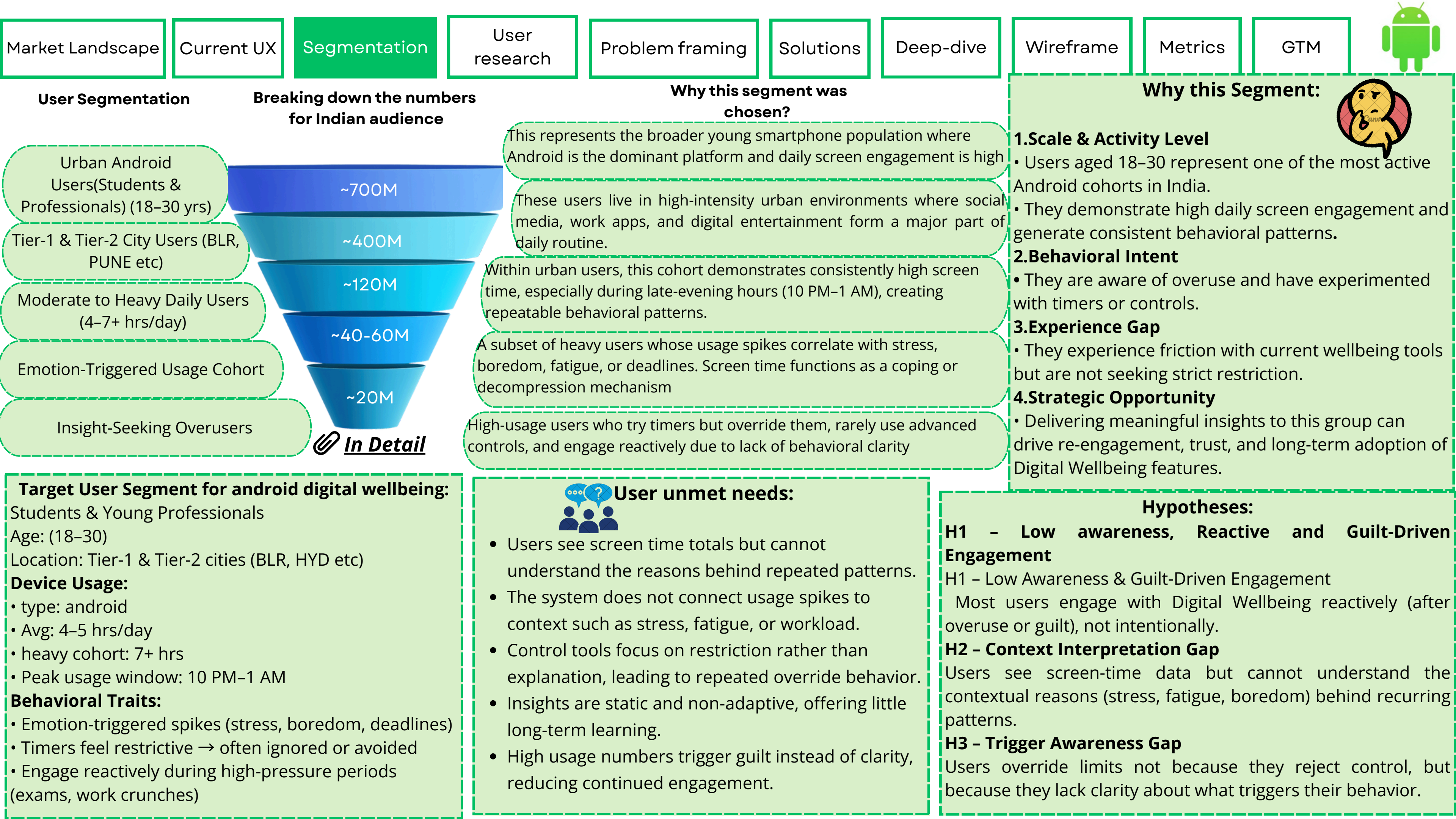


Uff.. i just shows stats and makes me feel guilty.



Where Does Engagement and trust Break?

- **Discovery & Motivation:** Buried in Settings, discovered reactively, with no onboarding narrative → users enter in a corrective mindset, not reflective.
- **Data Presentation Layer:** Shows raw numbers (hours, rankings, unlocks) without interpretation → data feels like a static report, not behavioral insight.
- **Control & Enforcement Layer:** Timers and Focus Mode rely on restriction → limits are easily overridden, with no reflection or adaptive learning.
- **Feedback & Learning Loop:** Weekly reports highlight increases/decreases but lack pattern detection or trigger identification → system remains static.
- **Emotional & Trust Dimension:** Numbers trigger guilt, shame, and defensiveness → users avoid dashboards, trust erodes, and engagement declines.



Key Insights from Primary Research (Quantitative and Qualitative Insights):

Survey response details

1. Awareness is shallow; engagement is mostly reactive

Most users show low active engagement with Digital Wellbeing-63.3% rarely open it, have only seen weekly alerts, or have never opened it at all. They check their usage only after long scrolling (30%) or weekly reports (20%), and 36.7% never check the dashboard at all.

Insight: The feature is discovered reactively, not intentionally, leading to a corrective mindset instead of reflection.

2.Users see the data but struggle to interpret the reasons behind it

Even though 36.7% say screen-time "completely" helps them understand their usage, deeper questions reveal a major gap:
43.3% don't understand night-time usage
43.3% don't understand what triggers them
40% don't know why certain apps pull them in
36.7% can't tell habit vs emotion

Insight: Users equate seeing the what with understanding the why, but they lack deeper contextual insight.

3.Trigger awareness is low timers feel irrelevant overrides rise

Scrolling starts due to notifications (26.7%), boredom (26.7%), or habit (20%), and 13.3% don't know their trigger at all 50% override timers often or sometimes. Top reasons: "Still felt like scrolling" (43.3%), "Timer didn't feel relevant" (36.7%).

Insight: High timer overrides indicate a gap between restriction and trigger awareness.

4.Users want explanations, not restrictions:

80% say "Why this session happened" would be useful.
93% say "Week in 3 Patterns" would help them reflect.

Insight: Users show strong interest in explanation-based insights.

Interview Response

User personas

Aarav | 26 | Bengaluru | Software Engineer | 5-7 hours (usage)

Context: Low awareness, mild guilt after overuse, checks the dashboard only after long scrolling or weekly alerts.

Goal: To feel reassured and in control without guilt, through simple, easy-to-understand insights.

Pain Points:
Forgets the feature exists
Only shows numbers" lacks meaning
Weekly reports trigger guilt, leading to avoidance.

JTBD: When I feel I've overused my phone, I want a simple, non-judgemental explanation so I can feel reassured without being restricted.



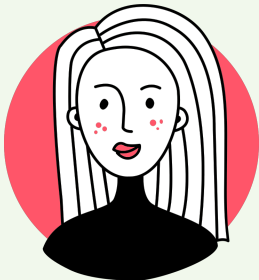
Riya | 20 | Pune | Student | 3-5 hours (sometimes 7+ during high stress)

Context: Moderate-to-heavy user, confused about triggers, night-time spikes, and motional patterns behind her usage.

Goal: To uncover the deeper why behind her patterns so she can make intentional changes.

Pain Points:
Confused about night-time use
Doesn't know what triggers scrolling
Unsure why certain apps pull her in
often overrides timers due to urge or irrelevance

JTBD: When my usage spikes repeatedly, I want to understand the trigger so I can break the pattern intentionally.



What is the true problem?

Use can see how much time they spend on their phones, but they cannot understand why their usage happens- what triggers their sessions, why patterns repeat (especially at night) or whether their behavior is driven by habit or emotion. Digital Wellbeing shows numbers not meaning.

Impact: Screen-time data lacks context, so users rarely change their behavior.

Who are the customers facing the problem?

Urban Android users (students and young professionals) aged between 18-30 with moderate-to-heavy daily screen time (3-7+ hours) who frequently rely on their phones for work, study, entertainment. they often engage with Digital Wellbeing reactively through long scrolling sessions or weekly alerts, but lack in-app support to interpret deeper patterns, triggers or emotional drivers behind their usage.

How do we know it's a real problem?

Based on Primary user research, the problem has been validated.

- 63% of users show low active engagement with Digital Wellbeing, indicating that the current experience doesn't often meaningful value.
- 36% never check their screen-time dashboard, revealing that raw numbers don't motivate reflection.
- 50% override timers because the system doesn't explain why their behavior happens, causing limits to feel irrelevant.

Value generated by solving this problem

For the business

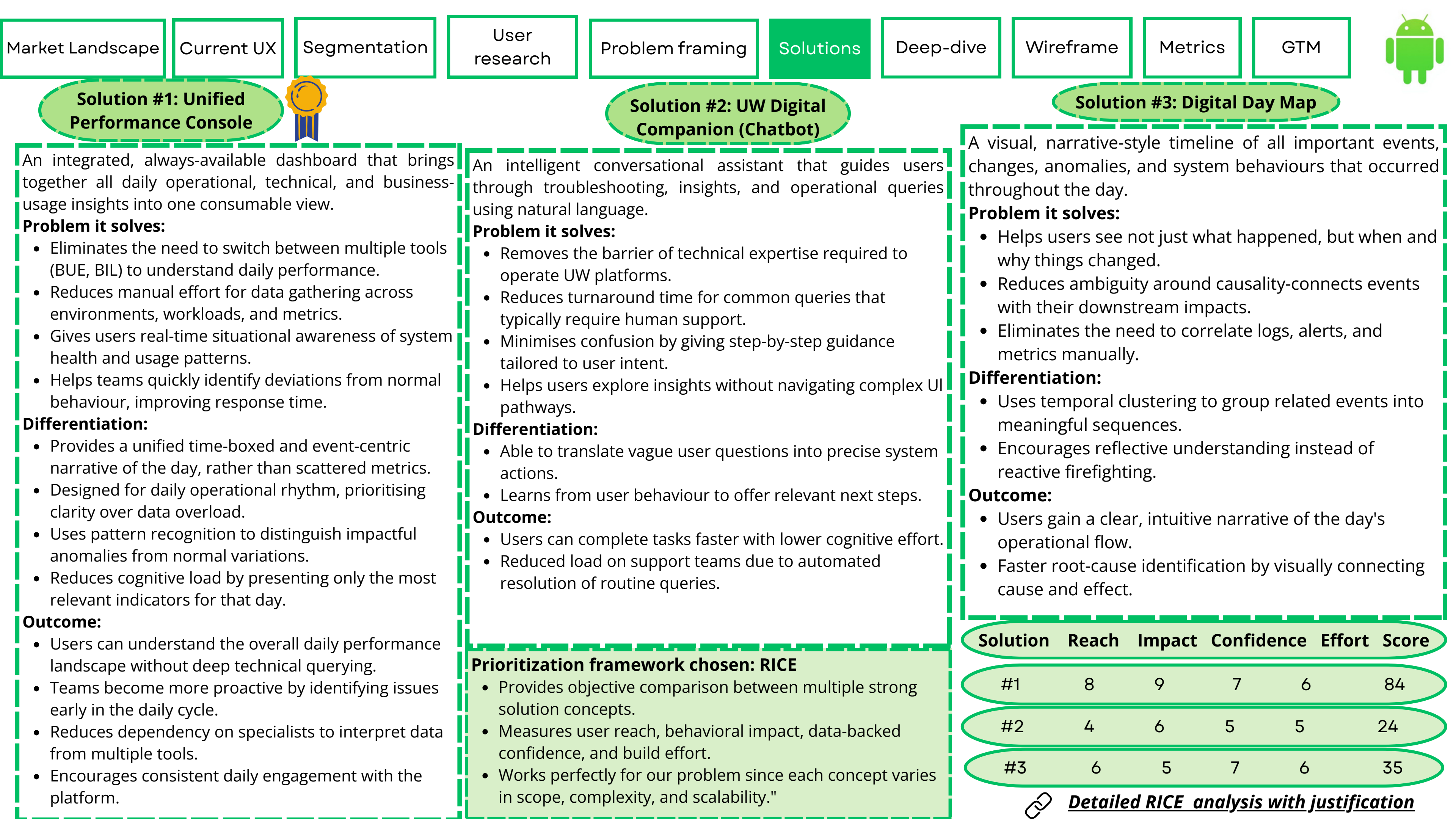
- Higher engagement with Digital Wellbeing features.
- Increased user trust and long-term adoption.
- Stronger differentiation in Android's wellbeing ecosystem
- Repositioning Digital Wellbeing from a tracking utility to a behavioral insight system.

For the users

- Clear explanation of triggers and recurring patterns (triggers, patterns, emotions).
- Reduced guilt and greater perceived control over digital habits.
- Ability to identify and break negative digital habits.
- A supportive wellbeing experience instead of a judgemental dashboard.

Why should we solve this problem now?

- Screen-time is rising across users, increasing stress, guilt and burnout.
- Digital Wellbeing has high visibility but low engagement, signaling a clear opportunity gap.
- Users are explicitly asking for meaningful behavioral insights (80-93% according to survey).
- Improving self-understanding builds long-term user trust and aligns with Google's Wellbeing mission.



Overview of the solution

What the system uses as inputs

- Raw device-level usage events (screen time, unlocks, app sessions, session duration)
- Notification triggers (what caused pickup)
- App-switch sequences within a session
- Time-of-day & day-of-week context
- Limit overrides (when and how often)
- User validation feedback (e.g., “Accurate” / “Adjust” trigger)

System combines behavioral (BUE) + pattern-level (BIL) signals.

What insights are generated

- Session Story: How a 42-min session unfolded across apps
- Trigger Identification: Why user picked up (notification / stress / habit loop)
- Trigger Map: Time-window based dominant causes (e.g., 55% notification at night)
- Weekly Patterns: Recurring behavioral loops (Late-night wind-down, Stress hop-loop)
- Override Insight: When and why limits were extended
- Trend Signals: Increasing / decreasing usage windows
- Personalized Suggestions: Context-based micro interventions.

Moves from “how much” → to “why” → to “what next”

How they are presented

- Consolidated dashboard (Daily snapshot)
- Session-level breakdown with flow visualization
- Time-segmented Trigger Map (Morning / Afternoon / Evening / Night)
- Pattern cards with frequency & duration
- Action-oriented suggestion cards (delay, mute, replace)

Focus on clarity, not raw numbers.

How users interact with them

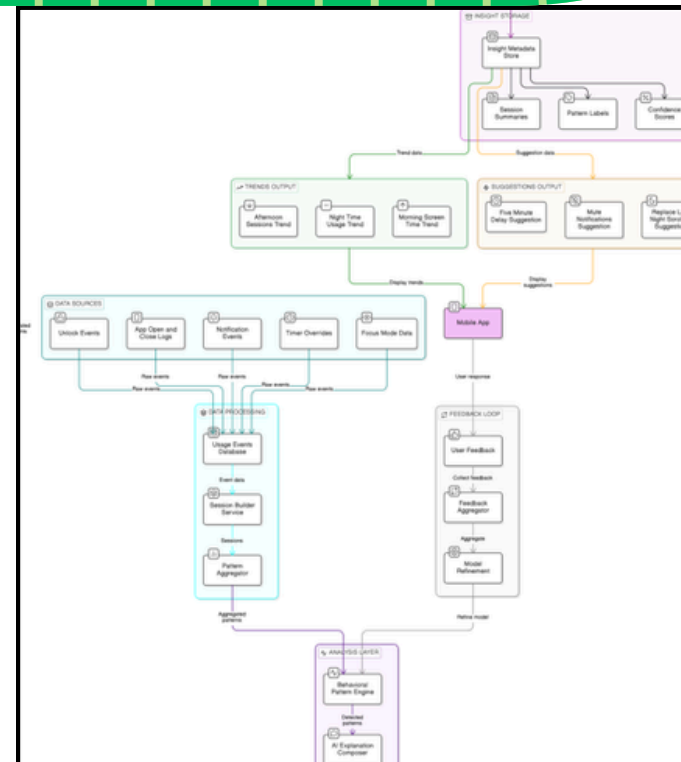
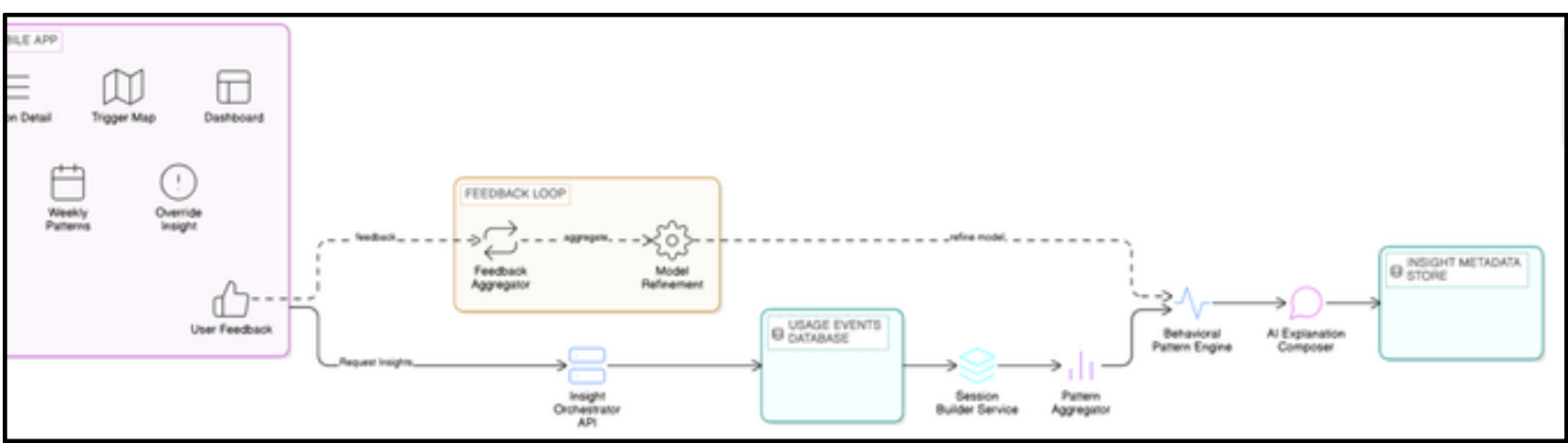
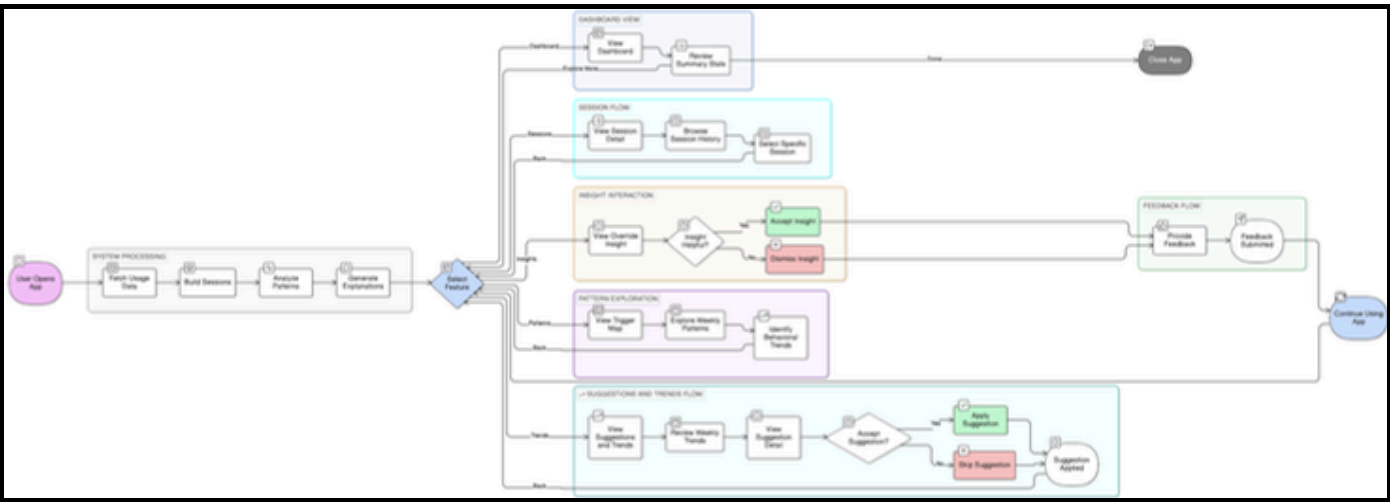
- Tap session to view full flow breakdown
- Validate or adjust detected trigger (“Accurate” / “Adjust”)
- Switch between Dashboard / Triggers / Patterns / Suggestions
- View override insight when limits are extended
- Take lightweight actions (5-min delay, mute notifications)

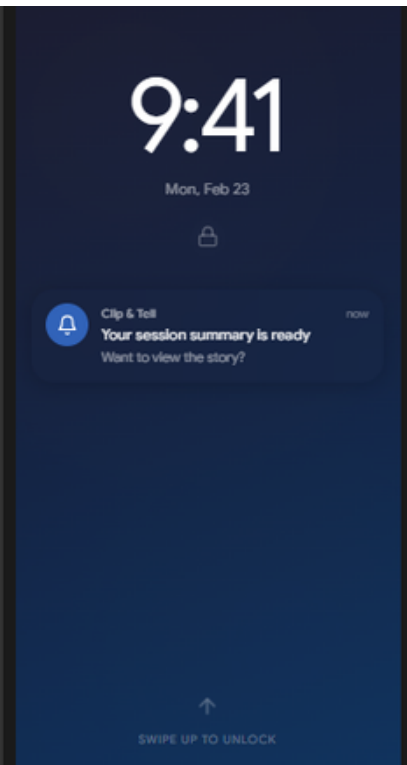
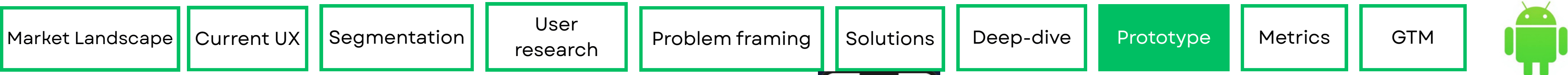
No heavy manual input required. No heavy manual input required.

system design

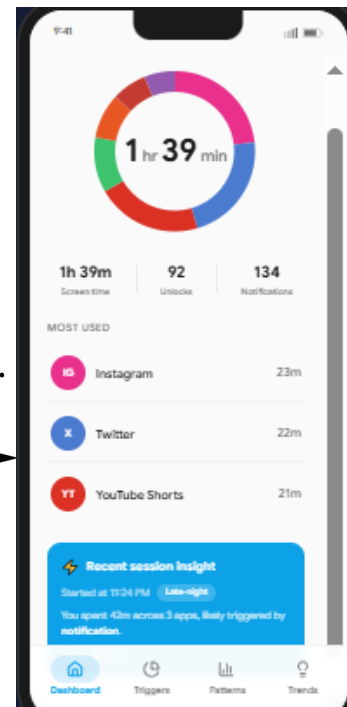
Use flow diagram

data flow diagram

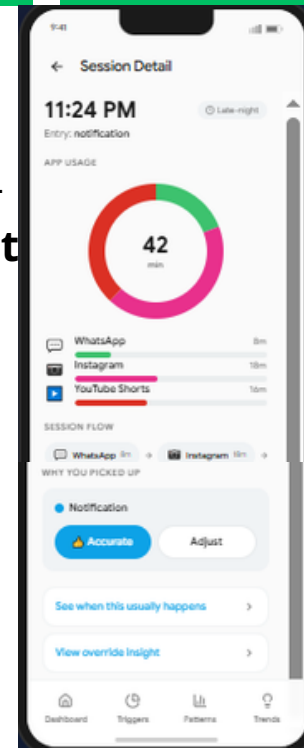




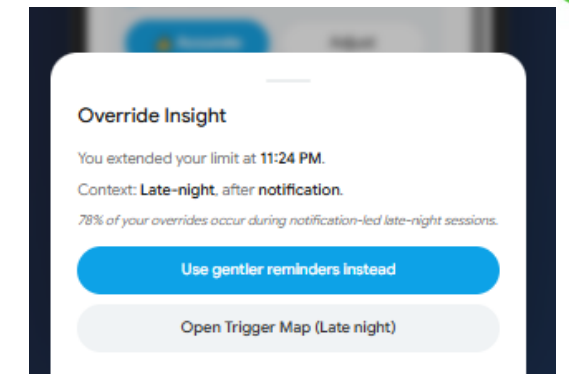
Lock Screen Notification
→ User taps the “Session Summary Ready” notification to open a contextual breakdown of their recent screen usage and trigger insights at the end of the day.



Dashboard Overview
→ User views total screen time, unlocks, top apps, and a system-generated **recent session insight** highlighting time, context, and probable trigger.



Session Detail View
→ On clicking recent session insight, user explores a detailed breakdown of the session, including app-wise time distribution, cross-app flow sequence, and identified trigger with the option to confirm or adjust the insight. And user can see when this trigger usually happens on clicking **see this usually happens button** which redirect to trigger map page



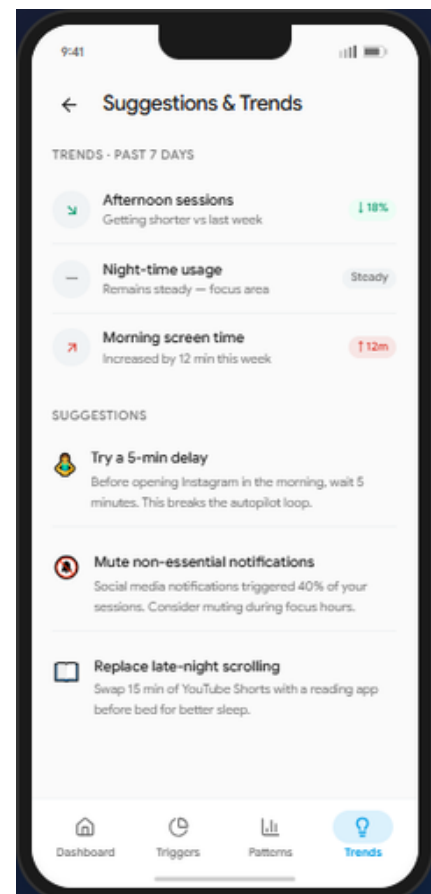
Override Insight
This pop up shows why did you extended your limit at particular time and it shows most % of usage triggers and asks to open trigger map and gentle reminder instead.

Wireframe Link

Prototype Link

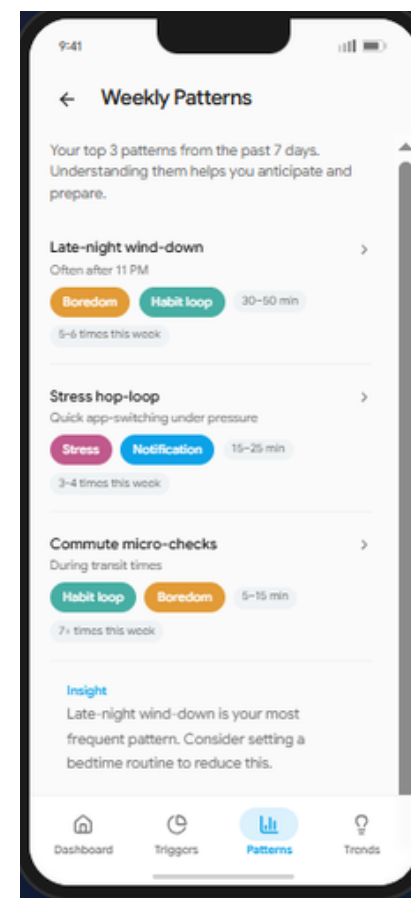
Suggestions & Trends View

→ User reviews week-over-week usage trends where which trigger/pattern is steady or improved is mentioned and receives personalized, trigger-based behavioral suggestions to proactively reduce high-risk screen-time patterns.



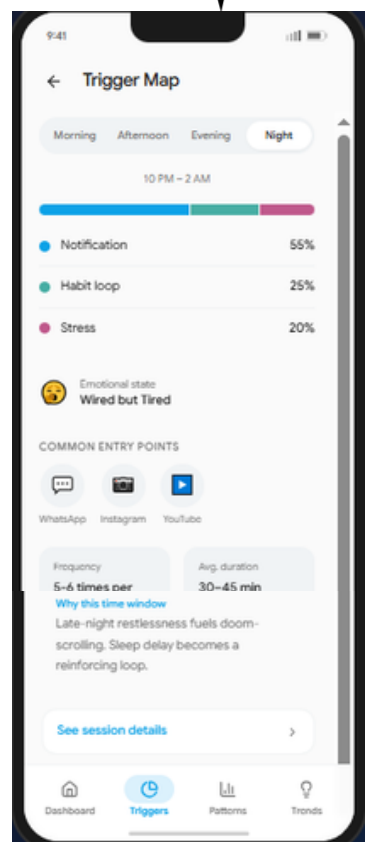
Weekly Patterns View

→ User can review top recurring behavioral patterns past 7 days with associated triggers, duration ranges, and frequency to identify dominant habits and anticipate future usage. On clicking upon any of the pattern it redirects to **session details** page. At end a small insight is present which based on weekly pattern provides most frequent pattern.



Trigger Map View

→ User switches between time windows (morning, afternoon, evening, night) to analyze trigger distribution (notification, habit loop, stress), emotional state patterns, and common entry apps for recurring sessions with frequency of this pattern in week with average duration and showing why this trigger happens in this particular time frame. Clicking on see session details redirects to **session detail page**



North-star Metric (NSM)

Insight Return Rate = % of users who view any insight (Session Story/ Trigger Map/ Weekly Pattern) in week N and return to view insights again in week N+1.
Target: 55-65%
Why: These metric captures whether user find the WHY-insights: meaningful, trustworthy, helpful for understanding late-night scrolling, emotional triggers and override behavior.
If IRR grows, solution is delivering value.

Leading Indicators

Metrics	Why	Target
Session Insight Open Rate	shows curiosity to understand WHY a session happened	65 - 75%
Drill Down Depth	Shows meaningful engagement, not just clicks	45 - 55%
Weekly Pattern View Rate	Indicates interest in reflective weekly behavior	50 - 60%

Lagging Indicators

Metrics	Why	Target
Repeat Insight Sessions (DAU/WAU for insights)	Measures reflective use over time	18- 25%
Reduction in late-Night Scrolling Duration	Direct result of understanding late-night triggers	10 - 20% decrease

Guardrail Metrics

- **Insight Dismissal Rate**
if too high ->insights may feel irrelevant or overwhelming.
- **Emotional Safety Score**
Ensures tone feels supportive, not judgemental.
- **Session Exit <10 sec**
Early exits signal confusion or discomfort, monitors emotional impact.

Experiment Plan:
A/B test the Behavioral insight feature against the standard screen-time dashboard.
Success will be measured by reduction in late-night sessions(11pm to 2am) and improved engagement with insight cards.



Go-to-Market strategy

Phase 1: Intent-driven discovery (launch)

Who: Users who already check Digital Wellbeing occasionally or after long sessions.
(students & professionals in Tier-1 and Tier-2 cities)

How: Surface insights natively inside the Digital Wellbeing flow right after the meaningful moments. Eg, after a long late-night scrolling session

Why: Validates that context-aware insights (session story, trigger map) reduce guilt and confusion without overwhelming users or feel judgmental.

Success signal: Percentage of Digital Wellbeing-dashboard viewers who open any insight card organically.

Phase 2: Value Confirmation and Habit Formation

Who: Users who have opened at least one insight (session story/Trigger Map/ Weekly pattern)

How: Improve microcopy clarity tone, reveal weekly patterns after enough data, introduce one optional weekly digest.

Why: Encourages repeat reflection, helping users understand late-night scrolling, routine loops and override habits-while keeping emotional safety intact.

Success signal: Insight Retention Rate: users who return to view insights in the next cycle.(week-to-week insight revisit rate).

Phase 3: Scaled Adoption with Guardrails

Who: High-confidence users who repeatedly open insights and explore deeper.

How: Offer pot-in, low frequency reminders aligned to real behavior cycles

Use meaningful-moment triggers only (eg, after a major late-night spike->not daily)

Why: Supports long-term reflection without turning the product into a monitoring tool
protects emotional safety and avoids 'surveillance' feeling.

Success signal: Sustained multi-week insight engagement without increased dismissal or discomfort signals.

Why the solution might not work

Risk 1: Insights may feel inaccurate or misinterpreted

Why: User might lose trust if the session story or Trigger Map gives a wrong explanation (eg, 'Boredom' when the user felt 'Stress')

Mitigation: Use the accurate “Accurate/Adjust” mechanism to let users correct the reason, and refine future insights based on their feedback.

Risk 2: Insights may feel repetitive and lose value over time

Why: Repeated patterns (eg, Late-night wind-down) may make users think "nothing new is happening" → reduces engagement

Mitigation: Highlight small changes inside the same insight (eg, “30% shorter than yesterday”), show weekly variations so experience feels evolving.

Risk 3: Insights may feel emotionally uncomfortable or judgmental

Why: Late-night scrolling, stress loops, or override behavior can make users feel exposed or guilty

Mitigation: Keep the language soft and supportive (eg, “wired but tired) avoid blame language and surface insights only at meaningful moments, not every session.

